

D724

Early Clinical in Elementary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

During a first-grade read-aloud in a bright room with a new carpet, a clinical candidate is asked to take observation notes. The cooperating teacher has taught for eighteen years. Which note is written as an objective observation?

- A. "The teacher's long experience kept the class calm."
- B. "Several students were bored by the story."
- C. "At 9:12, four of the 20 students turned away from the book and talked to a neighbor."
- D. "The read-aloud went well overall."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A candidate's log contains the note "The class did not understand fractions." What should the candidate do to make it an observation rather than an inference?

- A. Add "very" to make it more precise.
- B. Record the evidence instead, such as "12 of 22 students shaded 1/4 when asked to shade 1/3."
- C. Delete every note about student learning.
- D. Keep it, since the teacher agreed with it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A second-grade class lines up for lunch loudly every day, even though a colorful chart by the door lists the line rules. The school recently repainted the hallway, and lunch starts at 11:40. What is the best first step for the candidate helping with the routine?

- A. Model the lineup steps, have students practice them, and give feedback until it is smooth.
- B. Make the rule chart larger and brighter.
- C. Move lunch to a later time so students are calmer.
- D. Take away recess until the class lines up quietly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

In a third-grade science lesson on plant needs, the teacher asks, “Why might a plant in a dark closet turn yellow?” The candidate notes that the teacher calls on the first hand within one second, and the same three students answer most questions. The room has large windows and a class fish tank. What change would most likely widen participation?

- A. Move the lesson near the windows to show the plants.
- B. Ask easier yes/no questions so more students answer.
- C. Pause about 3–5 seconds before taking any answer.
- D. Always call only on students whose hands are not raised.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A fourth-grade teacher models how to find the main idea of a paragraph, thinking aloud for ten minutes, then assigns six paragraphs to do alone. Most students write the first sentence as the main idea. The lesson used a new set of animal articles the PTA bought. Which step was skipped?

- A. Guided practice, where the class works examples together with teacher support.
- B. The teacher model, where the teacher thinks aloud.
- C. A longer independent practice set.
- D. A different set of articles.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student teacher’s class does well during guided practice on two-digit addition but many students make errors when working alone. According to gradual release, what should the teacher do next?

- A. Move on to three-digit addition to keep pace.
- B. Return to guided practice with those students and check again before independent work.
- C. Assign more independent problems as homework.
- D. Go back and re-teach the whole lesson from the start to everyone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

In a kindergarten class decorated for fall, a teacher gives a five-question letter-sound quiz on Tuesday. That afternoon she regroups students for Wednesday's lessons based on which sounds each child missed. The quiz is printed on orange paper. How is the quiz being used?

- A. Summatively, because it is given midweek.
- B. Summatively, because it is a quiz with a score.
- C. As a diagnostic screener required for all schools.
- D. Formatively, because results guide the next lessons.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to judge how well each student met the standards at the end of a unit, and the scores go into the report card. What kind of assessment is this?

- A. Summative assessment.
- B. A pre-assessment.
- C. Formative assessment.
- D. An observation note.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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9.

A second grader can read words with short vowels alone but cannot yet read words with the silent-e pattern. With the teacher covering the e and uncovering it, the student reads them correctly. The student loves dinosaurs and sits near the door. Where should the next lesson aim?

- A. Multisyllable words, to push the student hard.
- B. Dinosaur books at any level, to build interest.
- C. More short-vowel words, since the student succeeds alone.
- D. Silent-e words with support that is faded over time.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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10.

After teaching a math lesson in a school that just started a new lunch program, a candidate writes: "The lesson went pretty well. I felt nervous at first, but the kids were nice. I liked the manipulatives." Her mentor said her voice was clear. What is the biggest gap in this reflection?

- A. It needs more detail about how nervous she felt.
- B. It lacks analysis with evidence of student learning and a specific change for next time.
- C. It is complete, since reflections are personal.
- D. It should mention her clear voice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A candidate's reflection says: "Next week I will add a turn-and-talk before independent work." Which part of the reflective cycle must come before this sentence to make the plan sound?

- A. A statement of how the candidate felt.
- B. Approval from the principal.
- C. A list of every activity in the lesson.
- D. An analysis, using evidence, of why students struggled.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A third grader who often rushes finally checks each subtraction answer by adding. The class is working in a room with a new projector, and the student recently joined from another state. Which teacher comment is most likely to make checking happen again?

- A. "Good job!"
- B. "You're so smart."
- C. "You checked each answer by adding it back. That's how mathematicians catch mistakes."
- D. "Welcome — you'll love it here."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

During a first-grade read-aloud ~~in a bright room with a new carpet~~, a clinical candidate is asked to take observation notes. ~~The cooperating teacher has taught for eighteen years.~~ Which note is written as an objective observation?

Target word: which note is objective **Decides:** Objective notes record observable actions or counts, not interpretations.

A	Camouflage	Answers the experience detail and states a cause, which is interpretation.
B	Confusion set	“Bored” is an inference about feelings, not something seen.
C	Correct	It records time, count, and visible behavior without judging why.
D	Adjacent category	A summary judgment belongs in analysis, not the observation record.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A candidate’s log contains the note “The class did not understand fractions.” What should the candidate do to make it an observation rather than an inference?

Target word: fix an inferential note **Decides:** Replace the conclusion with the observable evidence behind it.

A	Dropped element	Intensity words add no evidence; the observable behavior is still missing.
B	Correct	Observable counts and actions are the evidence; the conclusion goes in analysis.
C	Absolute language	Learning can be observed through student work and actions; only the inference needs rewriting.
D	Adjacent category	Agreement does not turn an interpretation into an observation.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A second-grade class lines up for lunch loudly every day, even though a colorful chart by the door lists the line rules. ~~The school recently repainted the hallway, and lunch starts at 11:40.~~ What is the best first step for the candidate helping with the routine?

Target word: best first step for a failing routine **Decides:** Posted rules alone do not teach a procedure.

A	Correct	Procedures are learned through modeling, practice, and reinforcement.
B	Dropped element	Keeps the posting and still skips teaching and practice.
C	Camouflage	Answers the schedule detail, which does not decide the routine problem.
D	Adjacent category	Punishment without teaching does not show students what to do.

4. Answer C Concept 3

In a third-grade science lesson on plant needs, the teacher asks, “Why might a plant in a dark closet turn yellow?” The candidate notes that the teacher calls on the first hand within one second, and the same three students answer most questions. ~~The room has large windows and a class fish tank.~~ What change would most likely widen participation?

Target word: change to widen participation **Decides:** Answers come within one second — no wait time.

A	Camouflage	Answers the room detail, which does not decide participation.
B	Inverted operation	Lowers thinking instead of giving time to think.
C	Correct	Wait time gives more students time to think and raises the number and quality of responses.
D	Absolute language	A rigid rule; the issue here is the missing pause.

5. Answer A Concept 4

A fourth-grade teacher models how to find the main idea of a paragraph, thinking aloud for ten minutes, then assigns six paragraphs to do alone. Most students write the first sentence as the main idea. ~~The lesson used a new set of animal articles the PTA bought.~~ Which step was skipped?

Target word: which gradual-release step was skipped **Decides:** The class went from modeling straight to independent work.

A	Correct	“We do” checks and builds understanding before “you do.”
B	Inverted operation	The model was done; the step after it was skipped.
C	Adjacent category	More independent work repeats the error without support.
D	Camouflage	Answers the materials detail, which is not the cause.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A student teacher’s class does well during guided practice on two-digit addition but many students make errors when working alone. According to gradual release, what should the teacher do next?

Target word: next step after a failed you-do **Decides:** Move back one step, not forward.

A	Dropped element	Skips the check that students are ready.
B	Correct	Release is gradual and can step back when checks show students are not ready.
C	Inverted operation	Moves forward while students still need support.
D	Absolute language	Some students succeeded; the need is targeted, not whole-class.

7. Answer D Concept 5

In a kindergarten class ~~decorated for fall~~, a teacher gives a five-question letter-sound quiz on Tuesday. That afternoon she regroups students for Wednesday’s lessons based on which sounds each child missed. ~~The quiz is printed on orange paper.~~ How is the quiz being used?

Target word: type of assessment by use **Decides:** Results were used to adjust upcoming teaching.

A	Adjacent category	Timing within a week does not decide; the use of results does.
B	Confusion set	Format does not decide the type; use does.
C	Camouflage	Adds a policy the stem never states.
D	Correct	Assessment is formative when its results shape instruction during learning.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher wants to judge how well each student met the standards at the end of a unit, and the scores go into the report card. What kind of assessment is this?

Target word: reverse: identify summative by purpose **Decides:** End-of-unit judgment recorded as a grade.

A	Correct	It measures learning at the end of instruction for a grade.
B	Confusion set	Pre-assessment happens before instruction, not at the end.
C	Inverted operation	Formative results are used during learning to adjust teaching.
D	Adjacent category	A record-keeping tool, not an assessment purpose.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A second grader can read words with short vowels alone but cannot yet read words with the silent-e pattern. With the teacher covering the e and uncovering it, the student reads them correctly. ~~The student loves dinosaurs and sits near the door.~~ Where should the next lesson aim?

Target word: target of instruction **Decides:** The student can do silent-e with help but not alone.

A	Adjacent category	Beyond what the student can do even with help.
B	Camouflage	Interest is useful but does not decide the instructional level.
C	Inverted operation	Stays in what the student already masters.
D	Correct	That is the zone of proximal development: possible with help, not yet alone.

10. Answer B Concept 7

After teaching a math lesson ~~in a school that just started a new lunch program~~, a candidate writes: “The lesson went pretty well. I felt nervous at first, but the kids were nice. I liked the manipulatives.” ~~Her mentor said her voice was clear.~~ What is the biggest gap in this reflection?

Target word: what the reflection lacks **Decides:** It has description and feelings but no analysis or next step.

A	Confusion set	More feelings still skip analysis and a plan.
B	Correct	A reflective cycle needs evidence-based analysis and a plan.
C	Absolute language	Reflection for growth requires evidence and a next step.
D	Camouflage	Answers the mentor detail; adds praise, not analysis.

11. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

A candidate’s reflection says: “Next week I will add a turn-and-talk before independent work.” Which part of the reflective cycle must come before this sentence to make the plan sound?

Target word: reverse: what supports the plan **Decides:** A plan should follow from analysis of evidence.

A	Adjacent category	Feelings are not evidence about learning.
B	Confusion set	Reflection does not require administrator approval.
C	Dropped element	Description alone does not justify the change.
D	Correct	The next step should be justified by what the evidence showed.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A third grader who often rushes finally checks each subtraction answer by adding. The class is working in a room with a new projector, and the student recently joined from another state. Which teacher comment is most likely to make checking happen again?

Target word: most effective praise **Decides:** Behavior-specific praise names the action.

A	Confusion set	General praise does not tell the student which behavior earned it.
B	Adjacent category	Praises a trait, not the behavior.
C	Correct	It names the exact behavior to repeat.
D	Camouflage	Answers the new-student detail and ignores the behavior.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Objective vs. inferential observation notes	Observation notes record what was seen and heard (actions, words, counts, times); interpretations go in a separate analysis column.	Writing judgments such as “the students were bored” as if they were observations.	“Which note belongs in the observation log?” or a note containing a feeling word.
2	Routines are taught, not posted	Classroom procedures work when they are explained, modeled, practiced, and reinforced, especially early in the year.	Believing a posted rule chart is enough for children to follow a routine.	A routine that breaks down even though the rules are on the wall.
3	Wait time	Pausing about 3–5 seconds after asking a question (and after an answer) raises the number and depth of student responses.	Calling on the first raised hand to keep the pace up.	Few students answer, and answers are short, right after a question.
4	Gradual release of responsibility	Move from teacher modeling (I do) to guided practice (we do) to independent practice (you do), checking understanding before each shift.	Jumping from a demonstration straight to independent work.	Students fail at independent work right after watching a model.
5	Formative vs. summative assessment	Assessment is formative when its results are used during learning to adjust teaching; summative when it judges learning at the end of a unit.	Classifying by format — assuming every quiz is summative and every discussion formative.	“The teacher uses the results to plan tomorrow’s lesson.”
6	Zone of proximal development and scaffolding	Aim tasks just beyond what a child can do alone but can do with support, then fade the support as competence grows.	Giving tasks the child can already do alone, or keeping supports in place forever.	A task a student can do “with help but not yet alone.”
7	The reflective cycle	Useful reflection describes what happened, analyzes why using evidence, and names a specific change to try next time.	Treating a summary of the lesson or a statement of feelings as reflection.	A reflection that ends without a next step or without evidence.
8	Behavior-specific praise	Praise that names the exact behavior (“You checked your answer with a drawing”) builds the behavior better than general praise.	Thinking “Good job!” is equally effective.	Choosing which teacher comment will most likely make a behavior happen again.

Course scope (public description): Early Clinical Experiences is a pivotal course designed to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical teaching skills. This course offers aspiring educators an immersive experience in real classroom settings under the mentorship of experienced teachers. Candidates engage in a range of activities, including observation, to develop a deeper understanding of classroom dynamics, student engagement, and effective instructional strategies. Emphasizing reflective practice, the course encourages participants to analyze their experiences, integrate feedback, and adapt their teaching methods accordingly. This experiential learning approach equips future teachers with the confidence and competence necessary to foster a positive and impactful learning environment for their students.